

STAGE TWO · PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

Professional Identity & Personal Brand

SESSION 1

Personal Professional Identity

FIRSTS B1-B6

Professional Introduction

- First 10 seconds shape credibility
- Rehearsed structure, not a memorized script
- Record it — timing and tone hide from you otherwise

Elevator Pitch

- Opportunities appear in short, unplanned windows
- Needs a natural close or ask
- One version for a recruiter, one for academia

Personal Brand Statement

- One sharp sentence beats five vague ones
- Test: can someone else paraphrase it back?
- Keeps your resume, LinkedIn, and conversations consistent

Professional Communication Style

- Style is judged faster than competence
- Greeting → purpose → ask → closing
- Too casual AND too stiff are both real risks

Professional Confidence Mindset

- Confidence is practiced, not innate
- One low-stakes rep this week
- Sets up B26 and B27 later in this stage

Personal Value Statement

- “Hardworking” differentiates no one
- I bring / which helped / achieve
- Ground it in one real, provable outcome

SESSION 2

Personal Brand Foundations

FIRSTS B7-B12

Personal Brand Strategy

- 3 words you want associated with your name
- One reinforcing action per word, this month
- A strategy, not a passive drift

Personal Brand Positioning

- “I'm the [role] who focuses on [intersection]”
- Too narrow fades, too broad disappears
- Test it on a genuine stranger

Professional Reputation Awareness

- Reputation forms whether you're watching or not
- Ask someone who'll actually be honest
- Curiosity, not defensiveness

Professional Image Audit

- Image judged before a word is spoken
- No universal standard — compare to your real field
- Behavior counts as much as appearance

Credibility Signals

- Built or eroded in small moments
- Specific deadlines beat vague promises
- Overpromising damages more than never promising

Professional Boundaries

- No boundaries → known as overloadable, not valuable
- Said well, boundaries build credibility
- Closes the loop on Sections 1-2

SESSION 3

Digital Presence & Online Identity

FIRSTS B13-B20

LinkedIn Profile

- Often the first place anyone looks
- Don't copy resume bullets verbatim
- Finish one blank section, live, today

LinkedIn Headline Strategy

- Your most visible text on the platform
- Role + specific focus + outcome
- “Student at University” wastes the space

Professional Bio

- 3 sentences, third person
- Open with your B3 brand statement
- Needs a throughline, not a list

Digital Footprint Audit

- Most employers search you first
- Incognito search — what's actually indexed
- A recurring habit, not a one-time check

Personal Website

- Signals initiative beyond LinkedIn
- Start minimal: name, statement, contact
- Simple and finished beats elaborate and abandoned

Professional Portfolio

- Shows, doesn't just claim
- Problem → role → process → outcome
- One strong project beats five thin ones

Professional Headshot

- Often the very first thing noticed
- Natural window light solves most problems
- Never a cropped group photo

Branding Color & Logo

- Optional — creative/design/entrepreneurial paths
- Two colors, one document, today
- Don't let this eat portfolio-building time

SESSION 4

Professional Communication

FIRSTS B21-B27

Professional Email Style

- Subject line + purpose + ask + closing
- First written impression, often
- Rewrite a real email you're sending this week

Professional Email Template

- Speed and consistency under time pressure
- Genuine personalization or it reads as hollow
- Builds directly on B21's structure

Meeting Presence

- Shapes reputation as much as output
- Neither silent nor dominating
- Prep one contribution point in advance

Question-Asking Skill

- Good questions remembered more than good answers
- Never one that's easily Googled
- Prepare two before you walk in

Professional Listening Skill

- Most people listen to respond, not understand
- Paraphrase before adding your own point
- Builds trust faster than almost anything else

Public Speaking Recording

- You underestimate your own filler words
- The playback is where learning happens
- Record your B2 pitch, watch it once

Video Introduction

- Standard now for internships, remote roles
- Good light, simple background
- Never visibly reading a script

SESSION 5

Professional Visibility

FIRSTS B28-B34

Thoughtful Social Media Presence

- Sustainable beats ambitious
- One realistic weekly commitment
- Recruiters look — visibility can actively help

LinkedIn Post Engagement

- Lower pressure than posting original content
- Never “great post!” — be specific
- Follow 5, comment thoughtfully on 1

Professional Content Share

- Commentary beats a bare share every time
- Shows critical engagement, not passive scrolling
- Two genuine sentences on why it matters

Blog/Article Post

- Original writing beats sharing others'
- One specific lesson, not a broad topic
- A durable artifact for interviews later

Thought Leadership Series

- One post shows skill; a series shows commitment
- Realistic pacing over ambition
- 3–5 topics connected to your first piece

Industry Trend Report

- Proactive awareness beyond coursework
- Genuine analysis, not just a summary
- Two credible sources, minimum

Professional Conversation Starter

- Beyond generic small talk
- Tied to the specific event or attendees
- Turns visibility into real connection

SESSION 6

Professional Materials

FIRSTS B35-B40

Resume That Stands Out

- Skimmed for 6–10 seconds — clarity wins
- Quantified achievements, not duties
- Tailor to the specific listing's keywords

Cover Letter That Works

- Tells a story a bullet list can't
- One specific company detail, not a template
- The opening line is the highest-leverage sentence

Business Card / Email Signature

- Makes you easy to remember and reach
- Simple beats cluttered
- Set it up live, right now

Portfolio/Project Showcase

- Speaking it is a distinct skill from writing it
- Two minutes, no notes
- Check in — don't just monologue

Online Portfolio Review

- You're blind to your own weak spots by now
- Ask one specific question, not “any thoughts?”
- Follow up to show you applied it

Digital Presence Plan

- The capstone — every platform, side by side
- Inconsistency reads as not-put-together
- A recurring check, not a one-time task

Stage Two, Complete

One inconsistency found and fixed, named out loud.